

Reporting Verbs

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Reporting verbs make the meaning precise. Group them by their pattern:

- 1** + to-infinitive: offer, promise, agree, refuse, threaten (She promised to call).
- 2** + object + to-infinitive: advise, warn, remind, encourage (He advised me to wait).
- 3** + -ing (or that-clause): suggest, recommend, admit, deny (She suggested taking a break).

A few take a preposition + -ing: apologise for doing, insist on doing, accuse someone of doing. Learn each verb with its pattern.

At a glance

Pattern	Verbs	Example
verb + to-infinitive	offer, promise, agree, refuse, threaten	He offered to help .
verb + object + to-infinitive	advise, warn, remind, encourage, invite	She advised me to rest .
verb + -ing	suggest, recommend, admit, deny	He suggested leaving early.
verb + preposition + -ing	apologise for, insist on, accuse (sb) of	She apologised for being late.

Learning objectives

- Can select reporting verbs to show the function of an utterance (CEFR B2).
- Can apply the correct pattern: to-infinitive, object + to-infinitive, or -ing.
- Can use prepositional patterns (apologise for, insist on, accuse of).

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Reporting Verbs · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. "I'll help you." → He offered ____ me.

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| A. to help | B. helping |
| C. help | D. that help |

2. "You should rest." → The doctor advised me ____.

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|------------|--------------|
| A. to rest | B. resting |
| C. rest | D. that rest |

3. "Let's leave early." → She suggested ____ early.

- | | |
|----------------|------------|
| A. to leave | B. leaving |
| C. me to leave | D. leave |

4. "No, I won't do it." → He refused ____ it.

- | | |
|----------|------------|
| A. to do | B. doing |
| C. do | D. that do |

5. "I'm sorry I'm late." → She apologised ____ late.

- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| A. for being | B. to be |
| C. being | D. that being |

6. "Don't forget the meeting." → He reminded me ____ the meeting.

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| A. to attend | B. attending |
| C. attend | D. of attend |

7. "It was me who broke it." → She admitted ____ it.

- | | |
|-------------|---------------|
| A. to break | B. breaking |
| C. break | D. that break |

8. Correct this: 'He suggested me to call a taxi.'

- | | |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A. He suggested calling a taxi. | B. He suggested me calling a taxi. |
| C. He suggested to call a taxi. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

9. "I promise I'll be there." → She promised ____ there.

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|----------|------------|
| A. to be | B. being |
| C. be | D. that be |

10. "You really should apply for it." → She encouraged me ____ for it.

- | | |
|-------------|-----------------|
| A. to apply | B. applying |
| C. apply | D. for applying |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. to help** — 'Offer' takes a to-infinitive: 'He offered to help me'.
2. **A. to rest** — 'Advise + object + to-infinitive': 'advised me to rest'.
3. **B. leaving** — 'Suggest + -ing': 'She suggested leaving early'.
4. **A. to do** — 'Refuse' takes a to-infinitive: 'He refused to do it'.
5. **A. for being** — 'Apologise for + -ing': 'She apologised for being late'.
6. **A. to attend** — 'Remind + object + to-infinitive': 'reminded me to attend'.
7. **B. breaking** — 'Admit + -ing': 'She admitted breaking it'.
8. **A. He suggested calling a taxi.** — 'Suggest + -ing' with no object: 'He suggested calling a taxi'.
9. **A. to be** — 'Promise' takes a to-infinitive: 'She promised to be there'.
10. **A. to apply** — 'Encourage + object + to-infinitive': 'encouraged me to apply'.